

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Christmas is for children!



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What was your Christmas like when you were a child?
- What was your favorite part about it?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about family life.
- I can discuss experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can talk about past habits.





Let's Explore!

We went to Boston **Common***

* A "common" is an open area of public land.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Vanessa:** What did you use to do with your families on Christmas when you were young?
- Sally:** We used to go skating. We would open our presents, then head to the Boston Common skating rink. We would drink hot chocolate and race around for hours!
- Vanessa:** Sounds like fun!
- Peter:** Have you ever heard of the Freedom Trail? Many families follow the trail on Christmas Day. It's kind of a tradition. Dad, Sis and I always walked the trail. We loved it and it gave Mom a break!
- Vanessa:** Gilly, Teddy and I wrote and performed plays for Christmas. We put together costumes and wrote out dialogues. We rehearsed for hours. Our various relatives were very good sports.
- Sally:** I haven't had a Christmas like this one for a while. We're a new kind of family don't you think?
- Vanessa:** Yes. We've had Christmas together for a few years now. We've made our own traditions. I would dread the holidays when I was alone here.
- Sally:** To many more Christmases together.
- Peter:** Cheers to that!





Let's Practice!

Peter, Sally and Vanessa talk about past family Christmases.

Instructions: Read the words. Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your answers and pronunciation with your instructor.

1. then / would / open / rink. / head / the / Boston / presents, / Common / skating / We / to / our

2. heard / Have / ever / the / Freedom / Trail? / you / of

3. We've / few / for / years / a / Yes. / now. / together / Christmas / had



Let's Practice!

They've all had fun at Christmas!

Instructions: Match the sentences in Column A with their corresponding missing Parts in Column B.

COLUMN A

1. Dad, Sis and I always
2. We loved it and it
3. We wrote and performed
4. Our various relatives
5. I haven't had a Christmas
6. We've had Christmas
7. We've made our

COLUMN B

- a. gawalked the Freedom Trail.
- b. ve Mom a break!
- c. were very good sports
- d. own traditions
- e. like this one for a while
- f. plays for Christmas
- g. together for a few years now.





Extension Activity

Talk about Christmas memories.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write about how you or other children felt on Christmas Eve.
- What did you or other children like doing at Christmas?
- What activities did you or they do?
- Who did you or they see?
- What gifts did you or they do?

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write about Christmas Eve traditions, activities, events and gifts.

☐ ☐

I write about activities I or others did on Christmas day.

☐ ☐

I write about who I or others saw.

☐ ☐

I write about gifts I or they received.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to go skating** (verb): to move around ice wearing skates
e.g. We went skating at the local arena.
- to race around** (verb): to run all over
e.g. The children race around the house laughing and squealing.
- to follow** (verb): to move behind someone or something
e.g. We followed the Freedom Trail.
- to give someone a break** (expression): to allow someone time to rest
e.g. We went out to give Mother a break.
- to put together** (verb): to construct
e.g. We would put together costumes for our plays.
- to rehearse** (verb): to practice a play
e.g. We rehearsed the play for hours.
- good sport** (noun): someone who accepts a bad situation with grace
e.g. Our various relatives were always good sports.
- to dread** (verb): to feel extremely worried or frightened of something.
e.g. I dreaded having Christmas alone.





Learning Points

Used to and Would to Talk About Past Habits

Used to and **would** are both used to talk about past actions.

We use **used to** to express something that we often did in the past, but don't do anymore. It is often used to talk about something that was a habit, or a way of life in the past. We use it to contrast past habits with present situations.

Used to can refer to situations as well as habitual actions.

We use **would** to talk about past actions and habits as well. **Would** only refers to actions, but not situations.

Structure	Meaning
I used to skate.	I don't skate anymore.
I would skate all day long.	It was my habit to spend all day skating.

Examples:

• **Gerry:** *What did you use to do with your families on Christmas when you were young?*

Ana: *We used to go skating. We would open our presents, then head to the Boston Common skating rink.*





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense versus The Simple Past Tense

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a finished action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** connected to the present.

Look at the chart about how to form the Present Perfect tense:

We use **have/has** + **the past participle** of the verb in Present Perfect sentences.

Base Form	Past Tense	Past Participle	Example
hear	heard	heard	Have you ever heard ...
make	made	made	We haven't had ...
have	had	had	I have had ...
be	was/were	been	They have been ...

Examples:

- *I haven't had a Christmas like this one for a while.*
- *Have you ever heard of the Freedom Trail?*
- *We've made our own traditions.*
- *Gilly, Teddy and I wrote and performed plays for Christmas.*
- *We put together costumes and wrote out dialogues.*
- *We rehearsed for hours.*

